

XIANGQI · VARIANT 1 OF 2

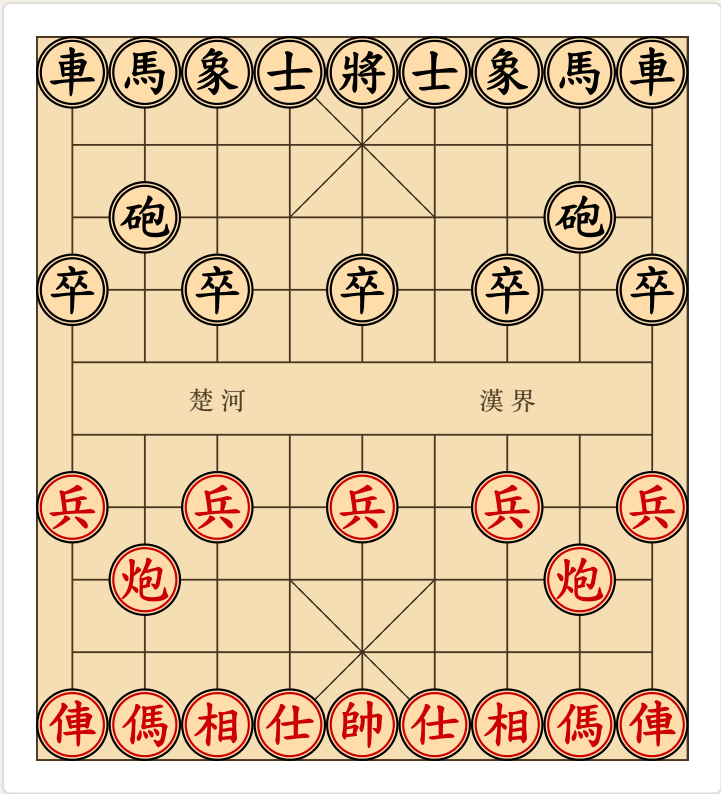
Standard Xiangqi

9×10
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

STANDARD XIANGQI

Xiangqi (, “Elephant Chess”) is the classical Chinese form of chess, played in China since at least the 7th century. It is the most widely played board game in China and among the most popular strategy games in the world. Ancient public domain origin: no copyright concern.



Standard Xiangqi — starting position

THE BOARD

The board is a 9×10 grid. Pieces are placed on the 90 intersection points, not inside squares. A river separates the two halves of the board between ranks 5 and 6. Each side has a **palace**: a 3×3 area marked with diagonal lines at the centre of the back three ranks (files d–f, ranks 1–3 for the bottom player; ranks 8–10 for the top player).

PIECES

Each side has 16 pieces.

PIECE	CHINESE	COUNT	MOVEMENT
General	/	1	One step horizontally or vertically within the palace only. Cannot face the enemy General on an open file (Flying General rule)
Advisor	/	2	One step diagonally within the palace only
Elephant	/	2	Exactly two steps diagonally. Cannot jump over a blocking piece. Cannot cross the river
Horse	/	2	One step orthogonally, then one step diagonally outward. Blocked if the adjacent orthogonal point is occupied ("hobbling the horse")
Chariot	/	2	Any number of points horizontally or vertically. The most powerful piece
Cannon	/	2	Moves like the Chariot when not capturing. To capture, must jump over exactly one intervening piece (the "screen") of either colour, with any number of empty points on either side of the screen
Soldier	/	5	One point forward before crossing the river. After crossing the river, may also move one point sideways. Can never move backward

STARTING POSITION

- ♦ **Chariots:** a1, i1 (opponent: a10, i10)
- ♦ **Horses:** b1, h1 (opponent: b10, h10)
- ♦ **Elephants:** c1, g1 (opponent: c10, g10)
- ♦ **Advisors:** d1, f1 (opponent: d10, f10)
- ♦ **General:** e1 (opponent: e10)
- ♦ **Cannons:** b3, h3 (opponent: b8, h8)
- ♦ **Soldiers:** a4, c4, e4, g4, i4 (opponent: a7, c7, e7, g7, i7)

The player with Red pieces moves first.

SPECIAL RULES

Flying General: the two Generals may never face each other on an open file with no intervening piece. A move that creates this position is illegal, even if the moving piece is not the General.

Stalemate is a loss: a player with no legal moves loses the game. This differs from Western chess, where stalemate is a draw.

Perpetual check: the checking side must vary the pattern or loses the game by repetition.

Perpetual chase: chasing an unprotected piece with the same piece repeatedly is restricted under tournament rules. The chasing player must break the cycle.

WINNING

Checkmate the opponent's General: place it under threat with no legal move to escape.

STRATEGY

Control the cannon mounts carefully: a Cannon without a screen to jump over loses its capturing ability. The Flying General rule creates tactical opportunities to threaten the opponent's General by clearing a file. Elephants are purely defensive, confined to their own half; develop Horses and Chariots early for offensive play.

ATTRIBUTION

Xiangqi. Public domain. Ancient Chinese origin, no copyright concern. Rules in accordance with the World Xiangqi Federation (WXF) standard.

XIANGQI · VARIANT 2 OF 2

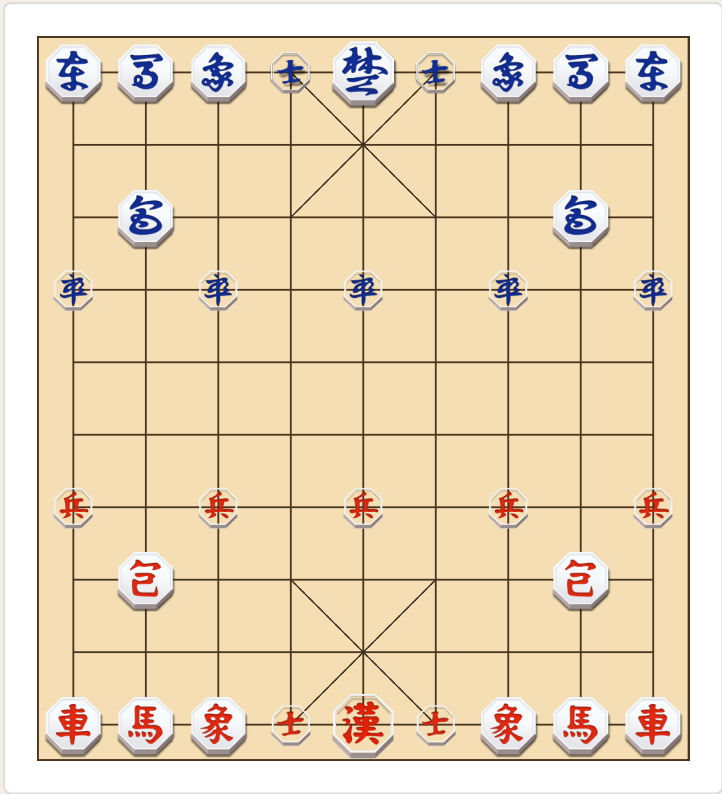
Janggi

9×10
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

JANGGI (KOREAN CHESS)

Janggi (장기) is the Korean form of chess, descended from the same historical lineage as Xiangqi but evolved independently into a distinct game. Key differences include no river, a different Elephant movement path, and a Cannon that must jump a screen piece to both move and capture. Ancient public domain origin: no copyright concern.



Janggi — starting position (inner elephant setup)

THE BOARD

The board is a 9×10 grid. Pieces are placed on the 90 intersection points. There is no river. Each side has a **palace**: a 3×3 area marked with diagonal lines (files d–f, ranks 1–3 for the bottom player; files d–f, ranks 8–10 for the top player). The General starts at the centre of the palace.

PIECES

Each side has 16 pieces.

PIECE	KOREAN/CHINESE	COUNT	MOVEMENT
General	/	1	One step orthogonally or diagonally within the 3×3 palace
Advisor		2	Same as the General: one step orthogonally or diagonally within the palace
Elephant		2	One step orthogonally, then two steps diagonally outward. Blocked if any intermediate point is occupied
Horse		2	One step orthogonally, then one step diagonally outward. Blocked if the first orthogonal step is occupied
Chariot		2	Slides any number of points orthogonally. May also move along the palace diagonal lines
Cannon		2	Must jump over exactly one non-Cannon piece to both move and capture . Cannot jump over another Cannon or use a Cannon as its screen
Soldier	/	5	One step forward or one step sideways, from the very start of the game

Key differences from Standard Xiangqi:

- ♦ No river: Elephants may move anywhere on the board
- ♦ Soldiers move sideways from the very start (no river-crossing promotion)
- ♦ Elephant follows a longer path: one orthogonal step, then two diagonal steps outward
- ♦ General and Advisor can move diagonally within the palace (along the palace diagonal lines)
- ♦ Cannon must jump to both move and capture (in Xiangqi, the Cannon moves freely and only jumps when capturing)
- ♦ Cannon cannot jump another Cannon or use a Cannon as its screen

BYUNSU: CHOOSING THE STARTING POSITION

Before play begins, each player independently chooses the arrangement of their Horses and Elephants. Four configurations exist per side:

LEFT SIDE	RIGHT SIDE	NAME
Horse, Elephant	Horse, Elephant	Inner Elephants (most common)
Elephant, Horse	Horse, Elephant	Left Elephant out
Horse, Elephant	Elephant, Horse	Right Elephant out
Elephant, Horse	Elephant, Horse	Outer Elephants

Han (Red) places their pieces first, then Cho (Blue) places second, giving Cho the strategic advantage of responding to Han's configuration. Cho moves first.

Fixed starting positions (inner elephant configuration shown in diagram):

- ♦ **Chariots:** a1, i1 (Han: a10, i10)
- ♦ **Guards:** d1, f1 (Han: d10, f10)
- ♦ **General:** e1 (Han: e10)
- ♦ **Cannons:** b2, h2 (Han: b9, h9)
- ♦ **Soldiers:** a3, c3, e3, g3, i3 (Han: a8, c8, e8, g8, i8)

Horse and Elephant positions at b1, c1, g1, h1 (Han: b10, c10, g10, h10) vary by chosen configuration.

SPECIAL RULES

Bikjang (laughing generals): when both Generals face each other on the same open file with no intervening piece, the player to move has two choices: make a move that breaks bikjang (move the General or interpose a piece), or pass their turn, which ends the game immediately as a draw.

Passing: a player may always legally pass their turn. Because passing is always available, stalemate is impossible in Janggi.

Bikjang and check simultaneously: when bikjang and check occur at the same time, bikjang takes priority.

TOURNAMENT MATERIAL COUNTING

In tournaments that do not permit draws, when bikjang is reached the remaining pieces are counted by value to determine the winner:

PIECE	VALUE (JEOM)
Chariot	13
Cannon	7
Horse	5
Elephant	3
Guard	3
Soldier	2
General	not counted

Han (Red) receives 1.5 bonus points (deom) because Cho (Blue) moves first. The 0.5 point prevents ties. The player with the higher total wins.

WINNING

Checkmate the opponent's General: place it under threat with no legal move to escape.

ATTRIBUTION

Janggi (장기). Public domain. Traditional Korean origin, ancient derivation from Xiangqi. Rules consistent with the Korean Janggi Association standard.